LET US LEARN

The Guardians of the Nation



Anandhan and Yazhini came home from school. After washing their face, hands and legs, they sat down next to their father. Their father was watching the news on the television. There were two bowls of chickpea sundal. They ate and watched a **ceremony** where people were paying respect to a helmet on top of a gun. "Dad, what is this place? What are they doing?" asked Anandhan. Dad replied, "This is Amar Jawan Jyoti, a **memorial** for the soldiers who died for our country. Every year, 7th December is observed as Armed Forces Flag Day. On that day, we remember the **sacrifices** of our soldiers for **guarding** our nation. It is a great **honour** to serve the nation by joining the army."



Why do the soldiers (people) die? When will it stop?

Yazhini proudly declared, "When I grow up, I will join the army and serve the nation." Anandhan said, "I will become a doctor, and treat the people." Yazhini asked, "Why don't you join the army and serve the nation like me?" Father **intervened** her and said, "Joining the army is not the only way to serve the nation. Each one of us can serve the nation in our own way." Yazhini asked, "Really dad? How can we serve the nation?" Father said, "Serving in the army is a grace, but not everyone gets a chance to serve. But, each of us has a role in our society and, by doing that role we are serving our nation."

Father continued, "I will tell you the story of Karmugilan. He was a doctor, who died, **serving** the people. He was young and talented. He went to the USA for studying. His parents were very proud of him. They thought that he would live in the USA and continue his practice. But to everyone's surprise, he came back to India and started treating poor people free of cost."